GROUP 3

SkillPass: Proving What You Can Do

The Problem

Cameroon's young people are the most educated generation the country has had, yet jobs remain out of reach. An Afrobarometer survey of 18 to 35 year olds found that about 80% have at least some secondary education while 36% say they are unemployed and looking for work. Only about 39% of 15 to 34 year olds are in employment, and in cities the pressure is sharper: unemployment among young people has been reported at around 18% in Yaoundé and 16% in Douala. Young people themselves name inadequate training, a mismatch between qualifications and job requirements, and a lack of experience as the main barriers.

The pain is felt on both sides of every hiring decision. A graduate sends dozens of applications holding only a certificate that employers cannot interpret, and is told to come back with experience she cannot get without a first job. Meanwhile a shop owner, hotel manager or construction supervisor receives a pile of identical CVs, has no way to know who can actually do the work, hires through relatives, and often regrets it. Capable young people end up in motorbike transport, petty trade or day labour, and many consider leaving the country.

The Two People Who Matter

Jobseeker	Employer
A graduate, trainee or self-taught young person with real ability but no proof, no experience and no network.	A business owner or manager who needs reliable workers fast and cannot afford a costly hiring mistake.

Your Mission

Design and build a system where jobseekers prove their skills through evidence rather than certificates, and employers find people who can genuinely do the job.

There is no ready-made answer. Your team must decide what to build, how it should behave and why. Use everything you have learned, and be prepared to defend each choice.

What Each Person Must Be Able To Do

Jobseeker

- Build a profile showing skills, projects and evidence of work.
- Take practical challenges that demonstrate ability.
- Apply for openings and follow the status of each application.

Employer

- Post an opening and say which skills it needs.
- Create or choose challenges that test those skills.
- Find, compare and shortlist the best-fitting candidates.

Each of them must have their own space in the system and see only what concerns them.

The Challenge Zone

These are hard on purpose. A strong team will not ignore them. Decide how your system answers each one.

- What counts as proof of a skill? Who decides whether a challenge was passed, and how do you keep it honest?
- How should the system rank candidates for a job? Make your ranking fair and be ready to explain it to a candidate who was not chosen.
- How do you protect a young person's personal information while still letting employers see enough to decide?

Push Further

When the core works, choose at least one of these to set your project apart.

- Show jobseekers which missing skill would unlock the most openings.
- Support short paid trials before a full hire.
- Let employers see how a candidate's skills grew over time.

What You Must Hand In

- A working system that your team can demonstrate live from start to finish.
- A short written explanation of the decisions you made and why.
- A 5-minute presentation in which every member can speak about any part of the system.

How You Will Be Assessed

Criteria	Marks
Understanding of the problem and the people affected	20%
Quality and completeness of the core requirements	30%
Thoughtfulness in the challenge questions	20%
Ease of use and clarity	10%
Reliability: it works when someone tries to break it	10%
Presentation and teamwork	10%

Start with the simplest version that solves the problem for both people, then make it better. A small system that truly works beats a large one that does not.